SOCIAL AND POLITICAL IDEALS

PRINTED CLAUSE AND ORDERING PROBLEM -> EQUALITY: WORTH, FORMS, OPPORTUNITY, EQUITY -> ROUSSEAU, MILL, MARX, AND THE METRIC -> LIBERTY: BERLIN, MILL, THE FOUR ENEMIES, THE THRESHOLD, NON DOMINATION -> JUSTICE: FORMS, CRITERIA, COMPENSATION, RAWLS, NOZICK, SEN, AMBEDKAR -> THE ORDERING VERDICT

Follow the numbered rail from Stage 00 to the final synthesis at Stage 13. Each card uses the internal grammar its content demands - spatial map, ladder, paired columns, dialectic, process, comparison matrix, timeline and synthesis. The grey E card is optional enrichment and never repairs a gap in the core.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • Topic 01 repaired in place and all prior artifacts unchanged

00 STAGE 00 — THE PRINTED CLAUSE, THE IDEALS TRIAD AND THE ORDERING PROBLEM

EQUALITY, JUSTICE, LIBERTY ONLY · EQUAL MORAL WORTH · PROTECTED SPHERE OF ACTION · WHAT IS DUE TO EACH · INDETERMINACY OF EACH IDEAL · ARCHITECTONIC ORDERING CLAIM · NOT A SURVEY OF DEMOCRATIC FORMS

OFFICIAL OWNER -> equality, justice and liberty only

EQUALITY asks in what respect persons must count as equals

LIBERTY asks which protected choices and capacities agency requires

JUSTICE asks what is due, by which rule and through which procedure

THE THREE QUESTIONS

- EQUALITY - in what respect must persons count as equals?
- LIBERTY - what may I do without interference, and with what capacity?
- JUSTICE - what is due to each, by which rule, through which procedure?

THE INDETERMINACY PREMISE

- Liberty is silent about WHICH liberties are basic.
- Equality is silent about WHICH equality is owed.
- A ranking must therefore range over both families.

OWNERSHIP FENCE AND CORPUS SHARE

- Democratic forms -> Forms of Government; obligation -> Individual and State.
- Reservation policy -> Caste owner; only the compensatory PRINCIPLE stays here.
- 14 of 112 socio-political parts, 2018-2025 - the paper's largest single share.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Institutions distribute status, chance, burdens and benefits, so equality and liberty each raise a claim that only an external criterion can rank.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Justice is architectonic because liberty and equality are each indeterminate about their own variants, so the ordering criterion must come from outside either ideal.

01 STAGE 01 — EQUALITY - EQUAL MORAL WORTH AND THE FOUR FORMS

EQUAL MORAL WORTH · EQUAL CONCERN AND RESPECT · FORMAL OR LEGAL EQUALITY · POLITICAL EQUALITY · SOCIAL EQUALITY · ECONOMIC EQUALITY · WORTH IS NOT SAMENESS

FOUNDATION -> persons count equally, so arbitrary hierarchy must justify itself

FORMAL -> equality before the law defeats legal privilege

POLITICAL -> equal vote and eligibility defeat oligarchy

SOCIAL -> the absence of stigma secures equal civic respect

WHAT EACH FORM SECURES

- Formal or legal equality secures the rule against legal privilege.
- Political equality secures a non-oligarchic public standing.
- Social equality secures equal civic respect free of stigma.
- Economic equality secures fair background conditions.

HOW EACH FORM FAILS ALONE

- Formal equality can survive as mere paper equality.
- Wealth can still distort actual political influence.
- Law alone cannot secure social respect; it needs reform and fraternity.
- Economic equalisation faces incentive and coercion objections.

DATED INDIAN ILLUSTRATION

- Articles 14-16: equality before law, non-discrimination, equal opportunity.
- Enabling clause in Articles 15 and 16 permit special provision.
- An enabling clause is a PERMISSION, never a philosophical justification.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The four forms are a ladder rather than a list, because each rung is secured only when the rung below it stops being merely formal.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Equality is best read as equal moral standing rather than sameness of share, and the four forms differ in what each secures and in how each fails alone.

02 STAGE 02 — A FAIR STARTING LINE OR A FAIR FINISHING LINE

EQUALITY OF OPPORTUNITY · EQUALITY OF OUTCOME · FORMAL VERSUS FAIR OPPORTUNITY · BACKGROUND INEQUALITY · CAPABILITY FLOOR · LEVELLING OBJECTION · EQUITY AS NEED-SENSITIVITY

OPPORTUNITY - CLAIM, OBJECTION, REPLY

- Offices and advantages should be open on fair terms.
- Objection: a starting line drawn across grossly unequal ground.
- Reply: fair equality of opportunity attends to background conditions.

OUTCOME - CLAIM, OBJECTION, REPLY

- Distribution should not leave large or unjust final disparities.
- Objection: levelling, paternalism and reduced autonomy.
- Reply: thresholds rather than identical holdings.

TEST SENTENCE AND RESIDUAL

- Open competition is not fully fair where one class alone can prepare.
- Equity means treatment answering to need and actual condition.
- Residual: the threshold is under-specified and must be named.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Fairness can be measured at the start, at the finish, or in the conditions that make the start meaningful, and each choice carries a different cost.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The real dispute is not opportunity against outcome but the distance between merely formal and genuinely fair equality of opportunity.

03 STAGE 03 — ROUSSEAU - NATURAL AGAINST ARTIFICIAL INEQUALITY

NATURAL OR PHYSICAL INEQUALITY · MORAL OR POLITICAL INEQUALITY · ESTABLISHED BY CONVENTION · PROPERTY AND COMPARISON · DEPENDENCE AND VANITY · NOT NATURAL RIGHTLESSNESS · DIAGNOSTIC, NOT PASTORAL

THE TWO CATEGORIES

- Natural or physical: age, bodily strength, health, intelligence.
- Moral or political: wealth, honour, power, dependence, social superiority.
- Only the second is established by convention and kept alive by institutions.

THE CONVERSION MECHANISM

- Property fixes advantage; comparison converts it into rivalry.
- Being stronger is natural; commanding another is moral or political.
- Civil society deepens dependence instead of merely recording difference.

WHAT THE DISTINCTION DOES NOT CLAIM

- Not that every inequality is conventional in origin.
- Not that natural inequality removes anyone's standing.
- The oppressive forms are socially produced, and so socially remediable.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Institutions magnify natural difference and then legitimise the result, which is why conventional hierarchy carries the burden of justification.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rousseau's distinction is diagnostic rather than pastoral, because it shows that the most oppressive inequalities are made by convention and maintained by institutions.

04 STAGE 04 — MILL - THE SIX SALIENT FEATURES AND THE LIMIT THAT COMPLETES THEM

EQUAL WORTH IN MORAL ACCOUNTING · EQUALITY BEFORE THE LAW · THE SUBJECTION OF WOMEN 1869 · INDIVIDUALITY · CUSTOM-MADE HIERARCHY · QUALIFIED ECONOMIC CONCERN · MANUFACTURED NATURE

1 equal worth in moral accounting - nobody is discounted by birth or station → 2 equality before the law and equal citizenship → 3 women's equality, argued in The Subjection of Women (1869) → 4 equality compatible with individuality and self-development → 5 hostility to custom-made hierarchy on both utility and justice grounds

6 qualified economic concern - reform, not coercive equalisation

THE GENDER ARGUMENT, EXACTLY

- Subordination is treated as a relic of domination, not a dictate of nature.
- The appealed-to nature is manufactured by the subjection it justifies.
- The evidence is therefore produced by the system under examination.

WHY THE FEATURES HANG TOGETHER

- Excluding half the members wastes capacities and violates utility.
- Removing hierarchy is a means of releasing individuality.
- Equality of status and chance is not uniformity of life plan.

OBJECTION AND ROUNDED VERDICT

- Objection: too individualistic to reach structural economic inequality.
- Reply: within liberalism he extends equality into social relations.
- Verdict: equal status without uniformity.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Mill removes hierarchy in order to release individuality, which is why the same doctrine makes him radical on gender and moderate on economic levelling.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Mill's equality is equal status without uniformity, and the feature that separates a strong script from an average one is the limit on coercive equalisation.

05 STAGE 05 — MARX - EQUITY AGAINST EQUALITY, AND THE RIGHT OF INEQUALITY

FORMAL EQUALITY · EQUITY AS NEED-SENSITIVITY · ABILITY AND NEED · WAGE CONTRACT APPEARS FREE · EQUAL RIGHT AS A RIGHT OF INEQUALITY · HIGHER STAGE, NOT A SALARY RULE · NOT MARXISM AS AN IDEOLOGY

THEME	FORMAL EQUALITY UNDER CAPITALISM	MARXIAN EQUITY
Distribution rule	equivalent exchange among legal equals	distribution by need in higher communism
Hidden reality	class power shapes production and appropriation	production organised for human flourishing
Labour relation	the wage contract appears free and equal	alienation and exploitation are overcome
Moral defect	one rule applied to unequals reproduces domination	unequal needs justify differentiated shares

THE CANONICAL FORMULA

- From each according to his ability, to each according to his need.
- Stated in the Critique of the Gotha Programme.
- Indexed to the higher stage, not offered as a market-time wage rule.

THE ILLUSTRATION AND ITS CORRECTION

- Equal wages for equal hours can still be inequitable with dependants.
- The deeper claim concerns the wage relation, not the scale of pay.
- Equality is a measure; equity answers to condition.

OBJECTION, REPLY AND QUALIFICATION

- Objection: need-based distribution is vague and weakens incentive.
- Reply: the principle addresses a stage beyond scarcity and alienation.
- Qualification: the two-stage structure is a projection, not a proven law.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — A single common standard abstracts from the very differences that decide whether a share is adequate, which is why equity is the more demanding ideal.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: For Marx an equal right can be a right of inequality, because one measure applied to unequal need, burden and starting position guarantees unequal effect.

06 STAGE 06 — EQUALITY OF WHAT - SEN, COHEN AND DWORKIN ON THE METRIC

CAPABILITY · CONVERSION OF RESOURCES · ACCESS TO ADVANTAGE · EGALITARIAN ETHOS · EQUALITY OF RESOURCES · BRUTE LUCK AND OPTION LUCK · INDETERMINACY WHERE POLICY ACTS

SEN - CAPABILITY

- The same resources yield different real freedoms across persons.
- Conversion varies with disability, age, gender, climate, health, position.
- Resources are not capabilities; possession is not effective freedom.

COHEN AND DWORKIN

- Cohen: inequities demanded by the talented may be moral bargaining power.
- Cohen: institutional justice can be undone by an anti-egalitarian ethos.
- Dworkin: neutralise brute luck while respecting chosen risk.

OBJECTIONS AND THE INTERIM VERDICT

- Capability lists are indeterminate; Sen prefers public reasoning.
- Luck and choice are hard to separate, yet the line remains clarifying.
- Verdict: equal status, fair opportunity and protection from domination.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Naming the metric converts an approving paragraph about equality into an examinable position that can be defended or attacked.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The modern egalitarian question is not whether to value equality but equality of what, and the answer chosen fixes every later evaluation.

07 STAGE 07 — BERLIN - TWO CONCEPTS OF LIBERTY AND THE REAL-SELF DANGER

NEGATIVE LIBERTY · POSITIVE LIBERTY · FREEDOM FROM INTERFERENCE · SELF-MASTERY · REAL SELF AND EMPIRICAL SELF · VALUE PLURALISM · NOT A REJECTION OF SELF-MASTERY

THE TWO QUESTIONS

- Negative: freedom from interference - Hobbes, Locke, Mill.
- Positive: freedom to be one's own master - Rousseau, Kant, Hegel, Green.
- They are different questions, not two quantities of one thing.

THE MECHANISM OF THE DANGER

- Once the person is split, no check remains on who speaks for her.
- Value pluralism explains Berlin's distrust of a single overriding project.
- Enabling conditions are distinguished from forced perfection.

OBJECTION AND THE HONEST VERDICT

- Objection: negative liberty ignores poverty, illiteracy and dependence.
- Reply: the distinction need not deny social preconditions of freedom.
- Berlin identifies a danger in one route, and does not refute the goal.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The split between a real and an empirical self is the step that converts an ideal of self-mastery into a licence for coercion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Berlin's target is not positive liberty as an ideal but the political inference that lets a ruler coerce the empirical self in the name of the real one.

08 STAGE 08 — FOUR SPECIFICATIONS OF FREEDOM, SORTED BY THE ENEMY EACH FEARS

FREE WHERE THE LAW IS SILENT · LIBERTY UNDER KNOWN LAW · GENERAL WILL · POSITIVE POWER TO ACT · HARM PRINCIPLE · OFFENCE IS NOT HARM · ENABLING, NOT PERFECTIONIST

THINKER	ENEMY OF FREEDOM	RISK OR OBJECTION
Hobbes	disorder; free where the law is silent	liberty becomes a residual gap left by power
Locke	arbitrary power; freedom under known law	property-centred liberty may mask inequality
Rousseau	dependence on another's private will	the general will invites an authoritarian reading
Green	incapacity; the positive power to act	the state may impose a preferred conception of the good

MILL'S HARM PRINCIPLE

- On Liberty (1859): coercion only to prevent harm to others.
- Self-regarding acts are presumptively immune; other-regarding acts are not.
- Offence or moral disapproval is not harm.

THE BEST DEFENCE OF THE PRINCIPLE

- The doctrine allocates the burden of proof rather than sorting acts cleanly.
- Coercion must show injury, not distaste, and paternalism stays exceptional.
- The instability of the line damages the classification, not the rule.

GREEN'S SAFE READING

- Enabling: enlarge effective capacity and leave the choice of ends alone.
- Education equips agency instead of prescribing a life plan.
- Perfectionism, not enablement, is what attracts Berlin's objection.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each definition of liberty is a remedy tailored to the particular enemy its author fears, which is why the four accounts diverge so sharply.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hobbes, Locke, Rousseau and Green differ less about the value of freedom than about its enemy - disorder, arbitrary power, dependence and incapacity.

09 STAGE 09 — THE THRESHOLD, TECHNOLOGICAL SOCIETY AND NON-DOMINATION

THRESHOLD OF COMPLEMENTARITY · EQUAL BASIC LIBERTIES · PRIORITY RULES · INFRASTRUCTURAL COERCION · CONVENIENCE IS NOT AUTONOMY · NON-DOMINATION · ENACTMENT IS NOT IMPLEMENTATION

AT THE BASE -> equal basic liberties are themselves a form of equality → BEYOND THE THRESHOLD -> market advantage and equalisation begin to collide → IN A TECHNOLOGICAL SOCIETY -> coercion migrates from law to architecture → PETTIT 1997 -> freedom is a secured standing, not an event-count → SKINNER 1998 -> the historical recovery of the republican tradition

THE THRESHOLD

- Free speech for all is at once a liberty and an equality of standing.
- Rawls's priority rules block trading liberty for aggregate welfare.
- Conflict appears only where advantage or equalisation expands.

TECHNOLOGY AND THE MIGRATION OF COERCION

- Algorithmic nudging leaves every formal option open.
- An interference-counter therefore registers no loss of freedom.
- Verdict: realisable under transparency, accountability and contestability.

NON-DOMINATION AND ITS COSTS

- Interference is an act; domination is a standing capacity to interfere.
- Non-arbitrary contestable law is freedom-constituting, not a subtraction.
- Objections: redundancy, and a partly indeterminate sense of arbitrary.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Liberty and equality reinforce one another at the base and compete beyond a threshold, and republican non-domination relocates that threshold.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Freedom is better specified as a secured standing than as an event-count, because the un-interfered-with dependant is unfree precisely as a dependant.

10 STAGE 10 — JUSTICE - THREE FORMS, FOUR DIMENSIONS, LEGALITY AND LEGITIMACY

FORMAL JUSTICE · PROCEDURAL JUSTICE · SUBSTANTIVE JUSTICE · RECOGNITION AND STATUS · LEGALITY IS NOT LEGITIMACY · PERSONS ARE OWED REASONS · PROCEDURE PLUS CRITERION

FORMAL asks whether announced principles are applied consistently

PROCEDURAL asks whether the deciding process was fair

SUBSTANTIVE asks whether the standard itself is just

CONCLUSION -> fair procedure plus a defensible substantive criterion

HOW EACH FORM FAILS ALONE

- An unjust principle can be applied with perfect consistency.
- A fair-looking procedure can run on a grossly unequal background.
- An imposed outcome without due process becomes a second arbitrariness.

THE FOUR DIMENSIONS

- Legal: impartial administration, and whether law answers to justice.
- Political: equal citizenship, voice and non-arbitrary public power.
- Socio-economic: benefits, burdens and real opportunities.
- Recognition: whether institutions reproduce stigma and humiliation.

SOURCE CONTROL

- Gauba, An Introduction to Political Theory, local PDF pp. 442-445.
- Socio-Political Philosophy, local PDF pp. 40 and 47-54.
- Cambridge Dictionary of Philosophy, local PDF pp. 489-490.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Formal, procedural and substantive justice evaluate three different objects, so satisfying two of them can still leave the third unmet.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A fair-looking procedure operating on an unequal background can satisfy consistency and process while failing the justice of the standard itself.

11 STAGE 11 — PLATO, ARISTOTLE, THE CRITERIA PROBLEM AND COMPENSATION

EACH DOING ONE'S OWN WORK · PROPORTIONAL EQUALITY · ARITHMETIC EQUALITY · NEED, DESERT, MERIT · SPHERE-SENSITIVITY · TRANSMITTED DISADVANTAGE · A TERMINUS IS OWED

CRITERION	FORMULA	PROPER SPHERE
Need	to each according to need	subsistence, health, basic education
Desert	to each according to effort or sacrifice	honours and recognition
Merit	to each according to competence for a role	offices and appointments
Contribution	to each according to productive value	wages, exchange, titles
Equal share	to each equally	civil and political rights
Compensation	to each according to unjustified loss	rectification of wrong

PLATO AND ARISTOTLE

- Rulers rule, auxiliaries defend, producers provide; reason governs the soul.
- Objection: frozen hierarchy; reply: a norm of competence and harmony.
- Distributive justice is proportional; corrective justice is arithmetic.

MERIT AGAINST DESERT

- Desert is backward-looking and moralised.
- Merit is forward-looking and functional.
- Collapsing them yields the claim that merit is a moral entitlement.

THE COMPENSATORY PRINCIPLE

- Exclusion transmits through wealth, networks, schooling and health.
- Formal equality from today ratifies an unequal starting line.
- It lapses when the targeted transmission no longer operates.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Aristotle's proportional formula is formally correct and materially empty until the relevant criterion for a given good is actually named.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Distributive justice is criterion-plural and sphere-sensitive, and injustice is most precisely defined as a criterion escaping the sphere where it belongs.

12 STAGE 12 — AGGREGATION, RAWLS, NOZICK, SEN AND AMBEDKAR

AGGREGATION OBJECTION · ORIGINAL POSITION · LEXICAL PRIORITY · DIFFERENCE PRINCIPLE · ENTITLEMENT, NOT PATTERN · NITI AND NYAYA · SOCIAL DEMOCRACY AND FRATERNITY

UTILITARIAN Justice maximises aggregate welfare and can sacrifice the few → RAWLS 1971 answers with a fair choice situation and a priority ordering → NOZICK 1974 answers with acquisition, transfer and rectification → SEN moves the question from correct rules to how people actually fare → AMBEDKAR adds that political democracy needs social democracy to survive

RAWLS - THE ORDERING

- Equal basic liberties are lexically prior to the second principle.
- Fair equality of opportunity precedes the difference principle.
- The original position is a device of representation, not a contract.

NOZICK - HISTORY AGAINST PATTERN

- Will Chamberlain: voluntary transfers dissolve any preferred pattern.
- The minimal state covers force, theft, fraud and contract only.
- Criticism: unclean starting points and under-specified rectification.

SEN AND AMBEDKAR

- Niti is institutional correctness; nyaya is justice as realised.
- Comparative judgement can rank alternatives without a perfect ideal.
- One vote each can coexist with deep civic humiliation.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each modern theory answers a defect in its predecessor, so the sequence is a chain of corrections rather than a list of separate opinions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rawls does not abolish inequality but civilises it, subjecting it first to equal basic liberties, then to fair opportunity, and only then to the difference principle.

13 STAGE 13 — DEBATES, TRAPS, PREVIOUS-YEAR ANCHORS AND THE ORDERING VERDICT

AXIS OF DISPUTE · CRITERION OF IMPROVEMENT · CONDITIONAL VERDICT · RESIDUAL PROBLEM · FOURTEEN OWNED PARTS · NO ONE-SIDED EVALUATION · ORDERING CRITERION MUST BE EXPLICIT

NAME the axis of dispute before describing either side → STATE the criterion of adjudication in the opening three lines → WORK one objection and reply fully rather than two half-way → CLOSE with a graded verdict that concedes something to the losing side

THE SIX DEBATES

- Hobbes, Locke and Rousseau; Berlin against Green.
- Rawls against Nozick; Rawls against Sen; Mill against Marx.
- Procedure against substance; Plato's question inherited by Rawls.

THE HIGH-COST TRAPS

- Equality as sameness; Berlin as anti-positive; Mill as licence.
- Rawls with equality first; Nozick as patterned; Sen as economics.
- Justice collapsed into legality or into fair procedure.

THE ANSWER SPINE

- 10 marks: doctrine, spine, one evidence unit and its limit, verdict.
- 15 marks: axis, both sides, one worked objection-reply, conditional verdict.
- 20 marks: thesis, criterion, rival, two residual problems, dated example.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Every question in this cluster is an adjudication with a hidden criterion, so the script that names the criterion first has already earned marks.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Liberty and equality are indispensable and jointly insufficient, so any defensible arrangement must make its ordering criterion explicit and publicly defensible.

E OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - ENRICHMENT ONLY

RELATIONAL EQUALITY · LUCK EGALITARIANISM · THIRD CONCEPT OR SPECIFICATION · PROMOTION LEDGER · NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

OPTIONAL DEBATES

- Equality of what, widened to a full metric dispute.
- Luck egalitarianism against relational equality.
- Non-domination as a third family, or a strengthened negative account.

STATUS AND LIMITS

- Capability and non-domination were promoted into Core on 15 August 2026.
- These residues would move into Core only if a part asked them directly.
- Do not displace Rawls, Nozick, Sen, Mill, Rousseau or Marx with them.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This stage is enrichment for a fifteen or twenty mark answer and is unnecessary for a competent core answer.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels